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Phonological Awareness Development Timeline
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Introduction

Children succeed to their highest potential in nurturing environments that support their learning across all domains.

Outcomes: The outcomes are statements of end-of-year expectations of learning and development for children 48 months (PK3) and 60 months (PK4) of age. They describe specific, observable skills, behaviors, and concepts that children should know and be able to do at the end of prekindergarten. Given children's individual differences, some children may demonstrate these indicators sooner, and some may demonstrate them later. The indicators listed for each age are not exhaustive.

Outcomes are numbered in the following manner:

- Student age is identified by "PK3" (up to 48 months) or "PK4" (up to 60 months).
- Learning domains are indicated with Roman numerals.
- Within each domain, separate skills are listed with an alphabetic indicator.
- Under each skill, the outcomes are then numbered sequentially.

PK3 Outcome

- **PK3.I.A.1 Child is building competence in controlling own body movements.**
- **PK3.I.A.2 Child can identify own physical attributes and indicate some likes and dislikes when prompted.**
- **PK3.I.A.3 Child begins to show awareness of own abilities.**
- **PK3.I.A.4 Child shows initiative in trying new activities but may not persist when obstacles or challenges arise.**

PK4 Outcome

- **PK4.I.A.1 Child is aware of where own body is in space and respects personal boundaries.**
- **PK4.I.A.2 Child shows self-awareness of physical attributes, personal preferences, and own abilities.**
- **PK4.I.A.3 Child shows reasonable opinion of his own abilities and limitations.**
- **PK4.I.A.4 Child shows initiative in trying new activities and demonstrates perseverance when attempting to overcome obstacles or challenges.**

The child outcomes are:

- **COMPREHENSIVE**–Cover the central domains of early learning and skills children need to succeed in school and provide sufficient scope and depth in each area.
- **INCLUSIVE**–Relevant for children with varying ability levels and diverse linguistic, economic, and cultural backgrounds.

Six domains (*Social and Emotional Development, Emergent Literacy: Language and Communication, Emergent Literacy: Reading, Emergent Literacy: Writing, Mathematics,* and *Physical Development*) include outcomes for both PK3 and PK4. Four domains *(Science, Social Studies, Fine Arts,* and *Technology*) do *not* include PK3 student outcomes as there is not sufficient research to clearly define typical behaviors of three-year-old children related to these skills. This does not mean that children of this age group should

not participate in the experiences related to the learning outcomes, but rather, the focus should be on engaging three-year-old's in the beginning stages of exploration of these concepts. This exposure will support children to develop a solid foundation of understanding, which will allow them to build and deepen their knowledge as they continue to learn and grow.

Child Behaviors: The child behaviors are examples that explain the competency of the outcome. The behaviors are not exhaustive of what a child may be able to demonstrate, rather they are behaviors that a child may demonstrate towards competency of the outcome.

Ultimately, the *Texas Prekindergarten Guidelines* are *not* intended to be used as a curriculum, assessment tool or checklist. They are *not* meant to be used in isolation, or to stifle the creativity of caregivers and educators. Rather, they are meant to serve as a resource for families, educators, and administrators to provide developmentally appropriate guidance and practices around young children's development and learning in the prekindergarten environment.

I. Social and Emotional Development Domain

While a prekindergarten education should include activities that strengthen cognitive skills, it must also provide for the development of the social and emotional competencies required for school readiness and success in life. The development of these personal and social skills enables children to build a sense of who they are and what they can do. Supportive, positive relationships between teachers and children are essential to implementing effective practices that support a child's social and emotional development. Children must establish positive relationships with adults and peers to participate effectively in the classroom community, assert independence in appropriate ways, and accomplish tasks that are meaningful to them without infringing on the rights of others. Children who can follow directions, communicate their wants, and needs effectively, and get along with other children are better prepared for kindergarten and beyond.

Early experiences influence brain development by establishing the neural connections that provide the foundation for language, reasoning, problem solving, social skills, behavior, and emotional health. Daily experiences such as transitioning from home to school, sharing a space or materials, resolving conflicts, and demonstrating empathy contribute to a child's social and emotional development. However, children benefit from direct instruction and repeated opportunities to practice these skills.

The Social and Emotional Development Domain of the *Texas Prekindergarten Guidelines* is divided into the following skills: self-concept, self-regulation, relationships with others, and social awareness.

A. Self-Concept

Central to understanding emotional development is the idea of self-concept: an ever-increasing level of conscious awareness of one's feelings, thoughts, abilities, likes, and dislikes, as well as awareness of one's body in space. Prekindergarten children's emerging ability to perceive these aspects of themselves at a conscious level distinguishes them from toddlers, who lack such awareness. Children begin to generate multiple answers to the question "Who am I?" which is an essential aspect of becoming competent in related areas, such as self-control and social/friendship skills. A child's identity includes cultural and linguistic factors, and the prekindergarten environment is one of the first public opportunities for children to recognize the uniqueness of their own home culture and language as well as accept and value cultures and languages different from their own. Early childhood educators must model the mindset of diversity as an asset in the classroom, school, and community.

PK3 Outcome	PK4 Outcome
PK3.I.A.1 Child is building competence in controlling own body movements.	**PK4.I.A.1 Child is aware of where own body is in space and respects personal boundaries.**

Child Behaviors

The child may:

- stay in designated personal spaces without intruding upon others (e.g., stays in own seat at lunch table without kicking feet or leaning against neighboring children or stays seated on assigned space during whole group instruction without distracting others)
- move around the classroom without stepping on materials or disrupting others' activities
- maintain appropriate personal space when speaking with others

PK3 Outcome	PK4 Outcome
PK3.I.A.2 Child can identify own physical attributes and indicate some likes and dislikes when prompted.	**PK4.I.A.2 Child shows self-awareness of physical attributes, personal preferences, and own abilities.**

Child Behaviors

The child may:

- use basic physical characteristics to describe self (e.g., hair color, eye color, or height)
- identify with a group or groups to which they belong (e.g., race/ethnicity, speaker of another language, family member, classroom group)
- use personal inclinations to describe self (e.g., favorite color, food, or game)
- use specific competencies to describe self (e.g., "I can tie my shoes." or "I am good at drawing.")

PK3 Outcome	PK4 Outcome
PK3.I.A.3 Child begins to show awareness of own abilities.	**PK4.I.A.3 Child shows reasonable opinion of his own abilities and limitations.**

Child Behaviors

The child may:

- choose to use the stairs instead of the climbing rope on the playground
- request help from adults when appropriate
- decline help politely when not needed (e.g., "No thanks, I can do it myself.")

PK3 Outcome	PK4 Outcome
PK3.I.A.4 Child shows initiative in trying new activities but may not persist when obstacles or challenges arise.	**PK4.I.A.4 Child shows initiative in trying new activities and demonstrates perseverance when attempting to overcome obstacles or challenges.**

Child Behaviors

The child may:

- independently select a new book or game in a learning center
- work on a puzzle until it is complete
- try several strategies to solve a problem before seeking adult assistance (e.g., when a crayon breaks, the child replaces the broken crayon with a new crayon instead of raising their hand to tell the teacher)

B. Self-Regulation

Prekindergarten children feel safer and function more successfully in the classroom when rules and routines are consistently implemented. A well-organized classroom with well-prepared activities helps children expand their attention span and build self-control and personal responsibility. As they encounter and overcome new and various social obstacles when interacting with peers, guidance from teachers will enable them to learn acceptable ways of dealing with social and emotional stress and/or excitement.

Self-regulation skills include three subskills: behavior control, emotional control, and control of attention. Subskills only appear in this section of the Texas Prekindergarten Guidelines and are represented by a lowercase letter at the end of the citation.

1. Behavior Control

PK3 Outcome	PK4 Outcome
PK3.I.B.1.a Child follows simple rules and routines when assisted by adults.	**PK4.I.B.1.a Child follows classroom rules and routines with occasional reminders from adults.**

Child Behaviors

The child may:

- demonstrate understanding of classroom rules
- respond appropriately to classroom behavior expectations

- identify and follow the sequence of the day's events, (e.g., "After centers, it's time to go outside.")
- participate in daily transitions when changing centers, moving from whole group to small group instruction, getting in line, etc.

PK3 Outcome	PK4 Outcome
PK3.I.B.1.b Child takes care of and manages classroom materials with adult assistance.	**PK4.I.B.1.b Child takes care of and manages classroom materials.**

Child Behaviors

The child may:

- appropriately handle materials during activities
- clean up and place classroom materials in appropriately labeled spaces
- put away personal belongings in their designated space

PK3 Outcome	PK4 Outcome
PK3.I.B.1.c Child manages own behavior with adult guidance and assistance.	**PK4.I.B.1.c Child regulates own behavior with occasional reminders or assistance from adults.**

Child Behaviors

The child may:

- communicate appropriately to make needs known
- wait for a turn (e.g., waits patiently at the water fountain for a classmate to finish drinking or selects another learning center when the learning center of choice is full)
- refrain from impulsive responses (e.g., waits for turn to be called on during group discussion or requests materials rather than grabbing them)

2. Emotional Control

PK3 Outcome	PK4 Outcome
PK3.I.B.2.a Child recognizes and expresses a range of emotions.	**PK4.I.B.2.a Child begins to understand the connection between emotions and behaviors.**

Child Behaviors

The child may:

- express feelings or respond with appropriate behavior (e.g., Child does not grab a toy back from a friend, but rather says, “I feel sad when you take my toy!”)
- verbalize understanding that all feelings are okay even though some behaviors may not be okay
- identify appropriate and inappropriate behaviors to common feelings

PK3 Outcome	PK4 Outcome
PK3.I.B.2.b Child is familiar with basic feeling words (e.g., happy, sad, mad, scared).	**PK4.I.B.2.b Child uses verbal and nonverbal communication to communicate basic emotions and feelings.**

Child Behaviors

The child may:

- demonstrate familiarity with a variety of feeling words (e.g., happy, sad, mad, scared, proud, worried, excited)
- label own feelings when prompted
- identify feelings of characters in stories or movies

PK3 Outcome	PK4 Outcome
PK3.I.B.2.c Child manages intensity of emotions with adult assistance.	**PK4.I.B.2.c Child is able to manage intensity of emotions more consistently, although adult guidance is sometimes necessary.**

Child Behaviors

The child may:

- use appropriate strategies to decrease level of distress (e.g., requests help when feeling frustrated with a task or seeks comfort from teacher when feeling sad)
- respond positively to adult guidance in using calming strategies (e.g., suggestions to separate self from frustrating situations or take a deep breath)
- show enjoyment while participating in activities that stimulate different types of emotions (e.g., playground games or music activities that require alternation of loud/quiet, fast/slow)

3. Control of Attention

PK3 Outcome	PK4 Outcome
PK3.I.B.3.a Child focuses attention on one task at a time but may not stay with it to completion.	**PK4.I.B.3.a Child sustains attention to personally chosen or routine (teacher-directed) tasks until completed.**

Child Behaviors

The child may:

- select and complete an activity before moving on to a new one
- create and carry out a sequence of dramatic play plans with a peer
- follow a familiar daily routine until the task is finished

PK3 Outcome	PK4 Outcome
PK3.I.B.3.b Child remains focused on engaging, teacher-led group activities for up to 10–15 minutes at a time.	**PK4.I.B.3.b Child remains focused on engaging, teacher-led group activities for up to 20 minutes.**

Child Behaviors

The child may:

- increase stamina on ability to pay attention during story time
- actively participate by sitting attentively (e.g., eye contact, raising hand, contributing to discussion) during circle time
- engage in a teacher-led small group activity despite what may be occurring in other small groups around her

C. Relationships with Others

As prekindergarten children enter school, they start forming relationships with the adults and other children in their school environment. Effective teachers offer support and assist children as they develop meaningful and rewarding relationships. During this developmental period, children often begin to develop special friendships with peers that increase their feelings of comfort, joy, and confidence in their social world. These experiences also help build a sense of empathy and caring for others.

PK3 Outcome	PK4 Outcome
PK3.I.C.1 Child forms positive relationships with adults and peers.	**PK4.I.C.1 Child uses effective verbal and nonverbal communication skills to build relationships with adults and peers.**

Child Behaviors

The child may:

- greet teachers and/or peers in the morning and say goodbye when leaving
- demonstrate they are listening to adults and/or peers when communicating (e.g., looks at speaker, responds to verbal or nonverbal exchanges)
- engage in conversations with adults and/or peers about what they are doing (e.g., shares stories and experiences from outside of the school)

PK3 Outcome	PK4 Outcome
PK3.I.C.2 Child assumes roles and responsibilities as part of the classroom community with adult assistance.	**PK4.I.C.2 Child assumes various roles and responsibilities as part of the classroom community.**

Child Behaviors

The child may:

- readily accept and carry out “classroom helper” assignments with adult assistance
- remind his teacher that it is his turn to shut off the lights
- respect other’s workspace and time with shared materials
- take responsibility for cleaning up classroom materials after use (e.g.,” We need to put the cars away, let’s get the box.”)

PK3 Outcome	PK4 Outcome
PK3.I.C.3 Child shows interest in peer play but may be less skilled in initiating and joining a group.	**PK4.I.C.3 Child shows competence in initiating social interactions.**

Child Behaviors

The child may:

- participate spontaneously in a variety of group activities, tasks, and play
- actively seek out partners and appropriately invite them to play (e.g., starts a game with classmates on the playground)
- seek out the teacher to ask questions, when appropriate

PK3 Outcome	PK4 Outcome
PK3.I.C.4 Child enjoys parallel and associative play with peers.	**PK4.I.C.4 Child increasingly interacts with peers during cooperative play scenarios that share a common plan and goal.**

Child Behaviors

The child may:

- demonstrate the ability to negotiate and compromise with peers to achieve a cooperative goal
- follow the lead of others (e.g., enters a center and adapts to the ongoing play of others)
- generate joint play goals and carry them out with at least one other peer

PK3 Outcome	PK4 Outcome
PK3.I.C.5 Child seeks adult help when experiencing conflicts with another child.	**PK4.I.C.5 Child initiates problem-solving strategies when experiencing conflicts with others and seeks adult support when necessary.**

Child Behaviors

The child may:

- follow conflict resolution steps, with teacher's guidance, to solve a dispute with a classmate
- ask an adult or peer for help when needed (e.g., "Teacher, Johnny isn't listening to me; he took my toy and won't give it back.")
- attempt to work out problems with a peer independently before seeking adult help

PK3 Outcome	PK4 Outcome
PK3.I.C.6 Child responds with concern when a child or adult is distressed.	**PK4.I.C.6 Child demonstrates empathy and caring for others.**

Child Behaviors

The child may:

- show emotions related to another's experience (e.g., expresses sadness for a character in a book or shows excitement when a classmate crosses the finish line in a race)
- demonstrate a desire to be helpful (e.g., volunteers to help a classmate clean up a spill)
- demonstrate consideration for a classmate (e.g., comforts a classmate who is crying, slows down to walk with a classmate who has an injury, befriends a classmate who is shy)

PK3 Outcome	PK4 Outcome
PK3.I.C.7 Child interacts with peers and may have preferred friends.	**PK4.I.C.7 Child interacts with peers and has preferred friends.**

Child Behaviors

The child may:

- talk with friends to plan their play (e.g., planning to play 'house' in the dramatic play/pretend and learn center)
- express interest in playing with a preferred playmate outside of school
- independently choose a work or play partner

D. Social Awareness

Prekindergarten children need adult support and guidance in learning how to socially interact with others. It can be a challenge for a young child to sense other people's emotions or to imagine what someone else might be thinking or feeling. Teachers can reinforce children's social awareness skills by facilitating peer-to-peer and adult-to-child interactions and asking thought-provoking questions with the support of rich, socially relevant educational materials.

PK3 Outcome	PK4 Outcome
PK3.I.D.1 Child shows interest in other people and their feelings.	**PK4.I.D.1 Child demonstrates an understanding that others have perspectives and feelings that are similar and/or different from her own.**

Child Behaviors

The child may:

- use words to express own and other's preferences (e.g., "I like to paint with red and Mary likes to paint with blue.")
- use words to express own and other's feelings (e.g., "Michael thinks that's funny, but I don't!")
- ask questions that indicate understanding that others may have a different perspective (e.g., "Do you like cats or dogs?" or "Were you scared of the thunder?")